

Chapter 27 — Biconsonantal / Geminate Disambiguation Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) identify the weak class (Biconsonantal or Geminate); (4) give the root and translate. Biconsonantal and Geminate forms are vocally identical — root knowledge is required. Answer key is on the last page.

Biconsonantal (II-ו/י): medial vowel letter ו or י retained in stem (e.g. וּכְנַח, שָׁמַח, בָּרַח, יָדַח). Geminate (R2=R3): same consonant at R2 and R3; no medial vowel letter (e.g. מָחַח, בָּבַב, חָח). Both classes share: Niphal perfect חָ (qamets); Hiphil perfect חָ (tsere); Hiphil imperfect יָ (qamets); Hiphil imperative חָ (qamets); Hiphil participle מָ (tsere).

Part A — Niphal: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Niphal. Identify whether each is Biconsonantal (medial ו/י) or Geminate (R2=R3). The prefix vowel pattern (חָ in perfect; יָ in imperfect) is identical for both classes.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
1	וּכְנַח	Gen 41:32	"the thing is ____ by God"					
2	וּבְבַב	1 Kgs 7:24	"the gourds ____ it, ten to a					
3	וּכְנַח	Psa 93:2	"your throne ____ from of old"					
4	וּבְבַב	Num 21:4	"they traveled ____ Mount Edom"					
5	וּכְנַח	Psa 57:8	"my heart is ____, O God"					
6	וּבְבַב	Num 34:4	"your border ____ from the					
7	וּבְבַב	Lam 3:40	"let us examine and ____ to the					
8	וּכְנַח	1 Sam 3:12	"when I ____ what I have					

Part B — Hiphil: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Hiphil. Hiphil prefix patterns: חָ (perfect) · יָ (imperfect) · חָ (imperative) · מָ (participle). These are identical for Biconsonantal and Geminate — root knowledge is the only distinguisher.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
9	וּכְנַח	Gen 6:18	"I will ____ my covenant with					
10	וּבְבַב	2 Sam 2:22	"____ from following me"					
11	וּכְנַח	Deut 18:15	"the LORD will ____ a prophet"					
12	וּבְבַב	Ecc 1:6	"the wind ____ to the south"					
13	וּכְנַח	Deut 27:26	"____ the words of this law"					
14	וּבְבַב	2 Sam 2:22	"____ from following me"					
15	וּכְנַח	1 Sam 2:8	"He ____ the poor from the dust"					
16	וּבְבַב	Ezek 41:7	"the structure ____ upward"					

Part C — Mixed: Stem and Class Both Unknown

Identify both the stem (Niphal/Hiphal/Qal/Hophal) and the class. Part C includes Qal and Hophal forms as distractors — not every Biconsonantal form is Niphal or Hiphil.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
17	בָּמוֹג	Isa 14:31	"all Philistia ____"					
18	הִמָּס	Josh 2:11	"the LORD ____ our hearts"					
19	יָרָם	Isa 52:13	"my servant shall be high and					
20	יָרָם	Psa 99:2	"great is the LORD, ____ above					
21	הִרָּיִם	Gen 14:22	"I have ____ my hand to the					
22	הוֹרָם	Lev 4:10	"just as it is ____ from the peace					
23	יָשׁוּב	Hos 14:8	"they ____ in the shade"					
24	יִשָּׁב	Lam 1:11	"all her people ____ to find					

Reflection Questions

- Items 1 (בָּמוֹג) and 2 (בָּסָג) have the same בּ prefix. What is the only reliable way to identify בָּמוֹג as Biconsonantal (root בּוּמ) and בָּסָג as Geminate (root בּבּס)?
- Items 9 (מִיָּקָה) and 10 (מִיָּסָה) both have הָ prefix (tsere). One retains a medial vowel letter; the other shows a contracted stem. Describe precisely what the medial position of each form looks like and how that reflects the root structure.
- Items 11 (מִיָּקָי) and 12 (מִיָּסָי) are both Hiphil imperfect 3ms. You encounter an unknown form יִלְדָּי. What question must you ask to determine if it is Biconsonantal or Geminate?
- Items 19 (מִיָּרָם) and 21 (מִיָּרָה) come from the same root (מֵרָם) but differ in stem. What vowel under R2 distinguishes the Niphal imperfect from the Hiphil perfect?
- Item 22 (מִיָּרָה) was classified as Hophal. How does the Hophal Biconsonantal prefix (יָרָה) differ from Niphal (יָרָה) and Hiphil (יָרָה), and what does it tell you about the semantics?

Answer Key

#	Form	Stem	Answer
1	נָכֹן	Niphal	Perfect/Ptc · 3ms/ms · Biconsonantal · נִּכּוּן — "is established / firm" — נִּ prefix (qamets); medial ו vowel
2	נָסַב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · נִּבְּסָ — "encircled / went around" — נִּ prefix (qamets); R2=R3=ב = Geminate;
3	יִכּוֹן	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִכּוּן — "is established" — יִּ + dagesh in כּ + holem-vav = Niphal
4	יִסַּב	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִבְּסָ — "went around" — יִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3 doubled) + holem =
5	הִכּוֹן	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִכּוּן — "is ready / prepared" — הִּ + dagesh + holem-vav = Niphal
6	הִסַּב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turned / went around" — הִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3) + holem = Niphal
7	נָשׁוּב	Niphal	Cohortative · 1cp · Biconsonantal · נִּבּוּשׁ — "let us return" — נִּ prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
8	נִתָּם	Niphal	Inf. Const. · — · Geminate · נִתְּמָ — "to be completed / finished" — נִּ prefix + holem = Niphal Geminate
9	הִקִּים	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "established / raised up" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; medial ו vowel
10	הִסִּב	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turned aside" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; no medial vowel letter,
11	יִקִּים	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִקֵּם — "will raise up" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal
12	יִסִּב	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִבְּסָ — "causes to go around / turns" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil; no
13	הִקֵּם	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "raise up! / confirm!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative;
14	הִסִּב	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turn aside!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative; same vowels
15	מִקִּים	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Biconsonantal · מִקֵּם — "one who raises up" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; medial ו
16	מִסִּב	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Geminate · מִבְּסָ — "going around / surrounding" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; no
17	נִמּוּג	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · נִמּוּג — "melted / dissolved" — נִּ prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
18	הִמִּס	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִמְּסָ — "caused to melt" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; R2=R3=ס = Geminate;
19	יִרָם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "will be exalted / lifted up" — יִּ prefix + qibbutz under R2
20	יִרָם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "is exalted / high" — יִּ prefix + holem under R2 = Niphal
21	הִרִים	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִרָם — "lifted up / swore an oath" — הִּ prefix (tsere) + chiriq-yod = Hiphil
22	הוֹרָם	Hophal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הוֹרָם — "was lifted off / removed" — הוּהִ prefix (holem-vav) = Hophal
23	יָשׁוּב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָבּוּשׁ — "will dwell / return" — Qal Biconsonantal — no Niphal נ or Hiphil
24	יָשַׁב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָבּוּשׁ — "returned / went around" — Qal Biconsonantal; holem vowel